

Lab: The Thaumatrope (Bird in a Cage)

Goal

To trick your eyes using science (Persistence of Vision).

What You Need

- A piece of cardboard (cut into a circle).
- String or rubber bands.
- Markers.

Steps

1. Side A

Draw a bird on one side of the circle.

2. Side B

Draw a birdcage on the other side. (Make sure it's upside down relative to the bird if you flip it vertically).

3. The Spin

Poke holes in the sides of the circle. Tie the string. Twist the string tight. Let go! The circle spins.

Discussion

- Do you see the bird INSIDE the cage?
- Why? Your brain blends the two images.
- This is how cartoons work!

What We Learned

Our eyes are slow. Our brains are fast. They work together to perceive the world.